

DX CENTRAL'S "HOW-TO" SERIES

THE DX CHALLENGE

The complete user guide for navigating the
DX Challenges app, submitting and editing
logs and more!



V1.0 | September 2026

DX Central / Loyd Van Horn





DX CENTRAL / SEASON 7

The DX Challenge

User Guide

Guide v1.0 | Appbuild1.0.0-rc10.4 | September 2026

START HERE: Sign in, save a public display name, add at least one valid receiving location, and select the Operating QTH actually used.

Before your first log

- 1 Open the production app and choose Sign in with Google.
- 2 Open Profile settings and save the display name you want shown publicly.
- 3 Add a receiving location. City/region lookup, a 4- or 6-character Maidenhead grid, and manual latitude/longitude are supported.
- 4 Use the Operating QTH selector near the top of the app to choose the location actually used for the reception.
- 5 Open Log entry and submit from the station list, manual entry, or bulk import.

Production app: <https://thedxchallenge.streamlit.app/>

1. Getting started

You need a signed-in account and one valid receiving location before submitting a reception.

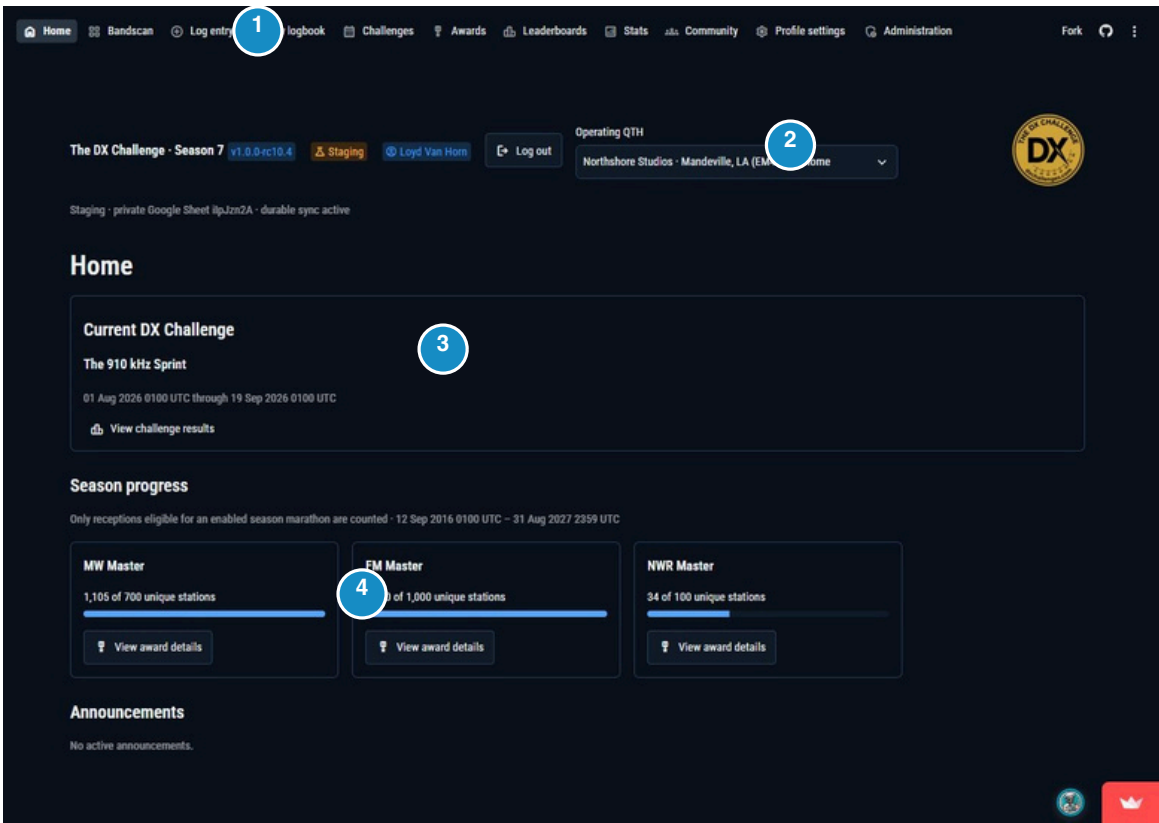
- 1 Open the production app and choose Sign in with Google.
- 2 Open Profile settings and save the display name you want shown publicly.
- 3 Add a receiving location. City/region lookup, a 4- or 6-character Maidenhead grid, and manual latitude/longitude are supported.
- 4 Use the Operating QTH selector near the top of the app to choose the location actually used for the reception.
- 5 Open Log entry and submit from the station list, manual entry, or bulk import.

GOOD TO KNOW: All reception timestamps are stored in UTC. You may display them in UTC or local time from Profile settings.

2. Navigation and global controls

The selected page tab is highlighted. On a narrower screen, remaining tabs are grouped under a “more” menu.

Page	What it is For
Home	Current challenge, season-award progress, and announcements.
Bandscan	Optional frequency-by-frequency view of your submitted reception history.
Log entry	Station-list, manual, and bulk-import submission workflows.
My logbook	Your season log, filters, protected export, corrections, and deletions.
Challenges	Current, completed, and upcoming sprint challenges plus challenge analysis.
Awards	Season-long award progress, leaders, endorsements, and counted receptions.
Leaderboards	Overall season standings and sprint standings.
Stats	Season counters, tables, charts, choropleths, station maps, and path maps.
Community	DXer shoutouts, Achievement Corner, release notes, and privacy information.
Profile settings	Public display name, themes, accessibility, QTHs, walkthrough, and support.



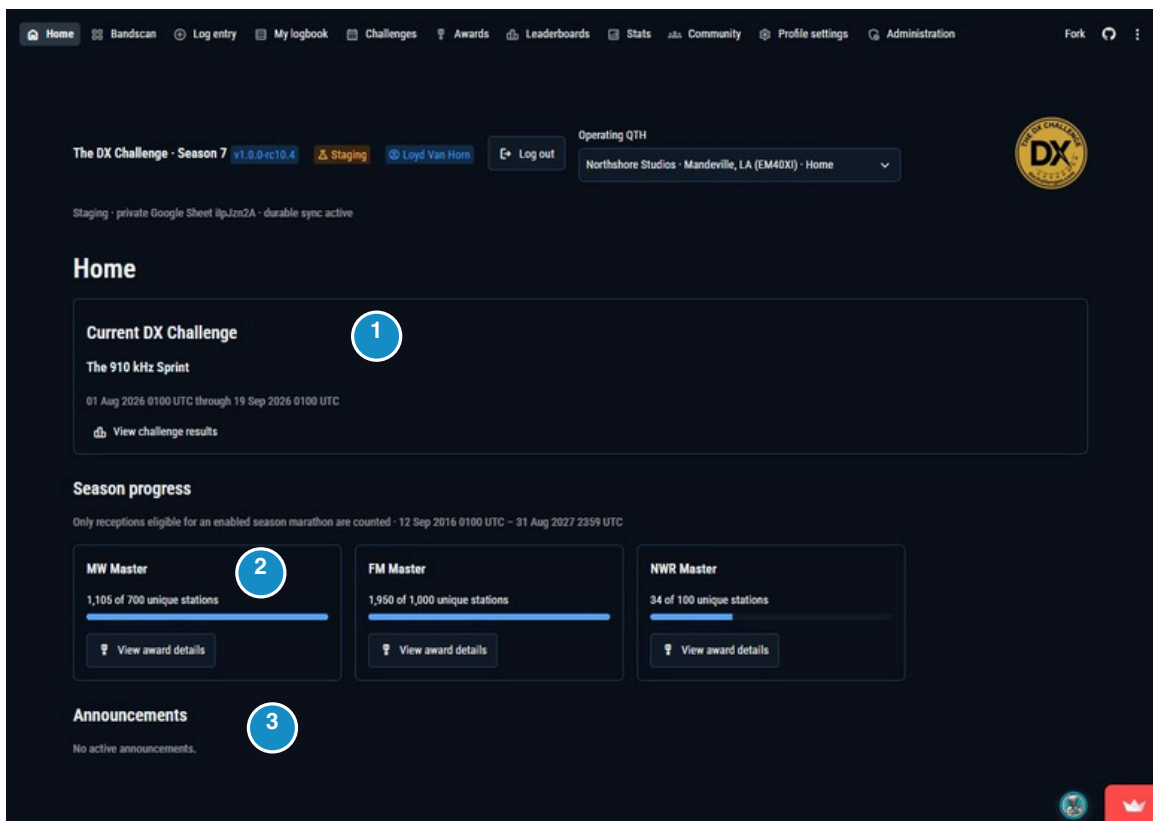
Staging screenshot with sample data. Numbered markers match the click-path list below.

- 1 Use the top tabs to move between user pages; your current page is highlighted.
- 2 Confirm the Operating QTH before logging. Changing it does not erase other saved locations or their logs.
- 3 The current challenge (if one is running) will be displayed at the top of the page with the date range active.
- 4 See your progress on season-long awards/challenges.

GOOD TO KNOW: Screenshots in this guide were captured in the isolated staging environment with sample data. Production totals and challenge dates will differ.

3. Home

Home is the season dashboard: the active challenge, your headline award progress, and current announcements.



Staging screenshot with sample data. Numbered markers match the click-path list below.

- 1 Current DX Challenge shows the active sprint and its UTC window. View challenge results opens the challenge page.
- 2 Season progress cards show MW, FM, and NWR master progress. View award details opens Awards.
- 3 Announcements appear below the progress cards while they are active.

4. Profile: identity, display, and accessibility

Update your public identity, color scheme and display options, time and distance preferences

- 1 Change Display name and save it. Historical leaderboards and awards update because ownership uses your stable account ID.
- 2 Choose Midnight blue, Deep ocean, Aurora, Ember, Daylight blue, or High contrast.
- 3 Turn on Larger interface text and/or Reduce animation and motion when helpful.
- 4 Choose UTC or local-time display, your IANA time zone, 12/24-hour clock, and miles/kilometers. Stored values remain UTC and miles.

GOOD TO KNOW: The email shown in the app is the authenticated account identity. It is not used as the public leaderboard name.

5. Profile: receiving locations and help

Every reception stays tied to the receiving location used, making home and portable operation coexist cleanly.

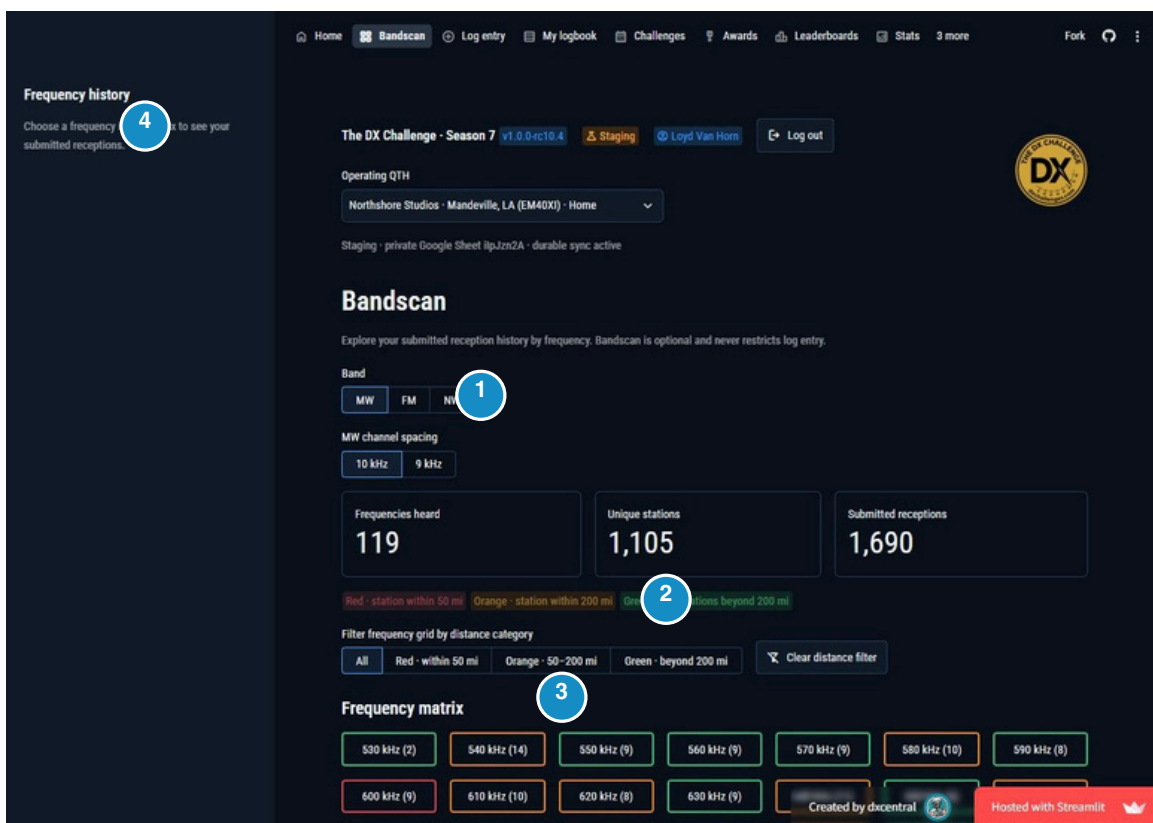
Staging screenshot with sample data. Numbered markers match the click-path list below.

- 1 Select Add a receiving location, then choose City / region, Maidenhead grid, or Manual coordinates.
- 2 Give the QTH a recognizable label and enter the requested place data. City/region lookup fills coordinates and a 6-character grid.
- 3 Optionally make the new location Home, then Save location. The dialog closes and the QTH becomes available in Operating QTH.
- 4 Use Set Home QTH to move your home designation. Existing locations and their reception histories remain available.
- 5 Unused locations may be deleted. A location tied to active logs is locked against deletion.
- 6 If a legacy location lacks coordinates or a valid grid, use Repair location data.
- 7 Under Help and support, restart the guided walkthrough or prepare a support/feature-request ticket.

GOOD TO KNOW: Select the actual Operating QTH before entry or import; distance, MW daypart, maps, and portable defaults depend on it.

6. Bandscan

Bandscan is a read-only visualization of frequencies and stations already in your logbook.



Staging screenshot with sample data. Numbered markers match the click-path list below.

- 1 Choose MW, FM, or NWR; MW also offers 10 kHz and 9 kHz channel spacing.
- 2 Read the counters for frequencies heard, unique stations, and submitted receptions at the selected QTH.
- 3 Use All, within 50 miles, 50–200 miles, or beyond 200 miles to narrow the matrix. Clear distance filter returns to All.
- 4 Red means a station within 50 miles, orange means one within 200 miles, and green means only stations beyond 200 miles.
- 5 Select a frequency box to open its Frequency history in the left flyout with full details on previous logs submitted on frequency.

GOOD TO KNOW: Bandscan colors describe likely local-interference distance, not whether logging is permitted.

7. Log entry: station list

The station list is the quickest entry method. Use our station database to quickly submit your logs!

The screenshot shows the 'Log entry' page with the following elements:

- Band:** A dropdown menu with 'MW' selected (marked with a blue circle 1).
- Entry method:** Three buttons: 'Station list' (selected), 'Manual entry', and 'Bulk import'.
- Frequency:** A dropdown menu with '88.1 MHz' selected (marked with a blue circle 2).
- Limit station list to 200 miles:** A toggle switch that is currently turned off.
- Filter station list:** A dropdown menu with a downward arrow (marked with a blue circle 3).
- Station list table:** A table with columns: Frequency, Station, City, State / province, Country, County / parish, Grid, and Miles. The table contains 10 rows of sample data. The 'City' column for the 4th row, 'CLEVELAND', is marked with a blue circle 4.
- Filter dropdown menu:** A menu that appears when the 'Filter station list' dropdown is clicked, showing options: 'Select all', '(index)', 'Frequency', 'Station', 'City', 'State / province', 'Country', 'County / parish', 'Grid', and 'Miles'.

Staging screenshot with sample data. Numbered markers match the click-path list below.

- 1 Choose MW, FM, or NWR. Band and frequency selections stay in place after a successful submission.
- 2 Choose a frequency from the list or use Previous/Next. MW includes both 10 kHz and 9 kHz split frequencies.
- 3 The full distance-sorted station list is shown by default. Turn on the 200-mile limit only when you want nearby stations.
- 4 Open Filter station list to search call/station name, city, state/province, country, county/parish, or grid; then clear filters when done.
- 5 Previously logged stations are highlighted in green and labeled in History.
- 6 Select one station row to open Review reception below the list. The log is not complete until you hit the “submit reception” button.

GOOD TO KNOW: During an active challenge on the selected band, Active challenge filter limits the frequency selector to eligible frequencies and starts at the lowest one. Turn it off to restore the full band.

8. Review, manual entry, and reception details

Every one-at-a-time log requires a review. Review your reception details so you can verify timing, propagation, receiver context,

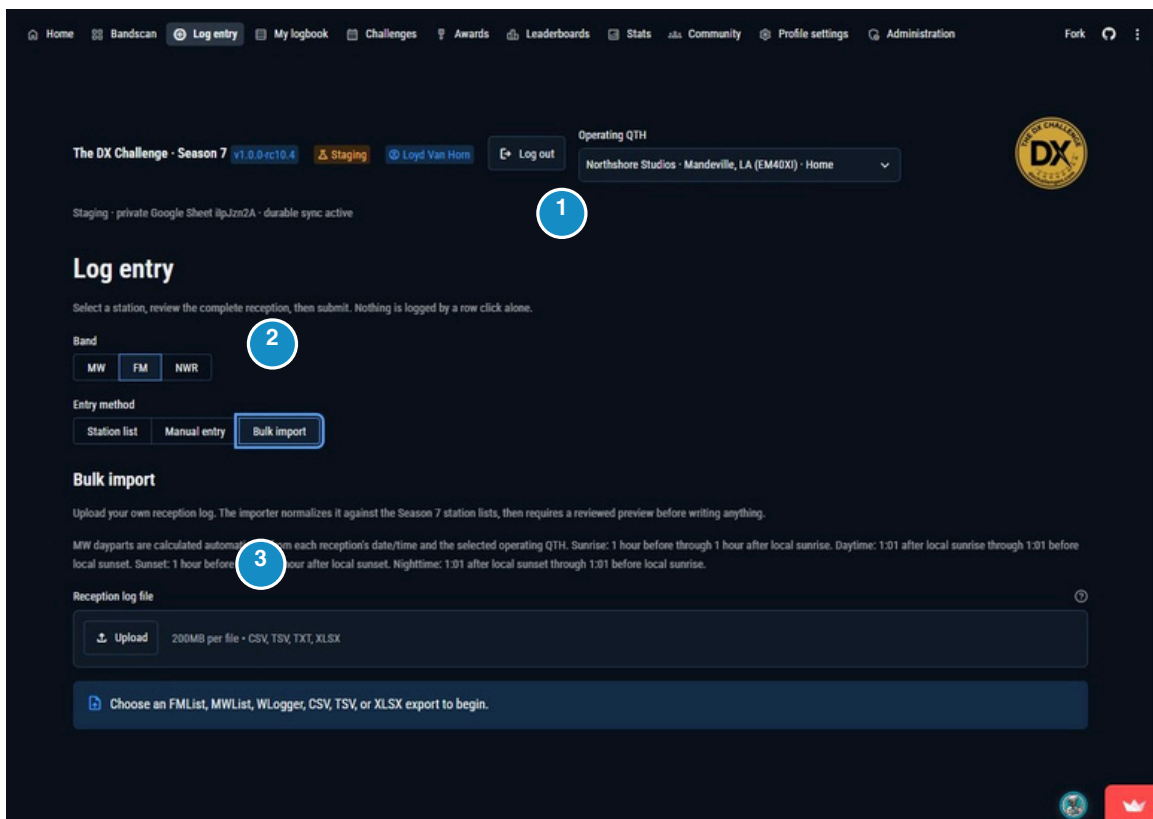
Staging screenshot with sample data. Numbered markers match the click-path list below.

- 1 For a station missing from the list, choose Manual entry.
- 2 Enter call/name, city, state/province/region, and country, then Resolve station location. Manual stations are accepted with pending review status; the app resolves coordinates/grid where possible.
- 3 After station-list or manual selection, Review reception opens before anything is submitted.
- 4 Live DX captures the current UTC date/time. From recording lets you enter UTC date/time and remembers the most recent recording date.
- 5 FM and NWR propagation choices are sticky. MW suggests a daypart from the selected QTH and reception time; review and adjust it if needed.
- 6 Received using an SDR and Portable operation are sticky between entries.
- 7 Add programming notes or ID details, then choose Submit reception.

GOOD TO KNOW: MW definitions: Sunrise is one hour before through one hour after local sunrise; Sunset is one hour before through one hour after local sunset; Daytime and Nighttime fill the intervals between those windows.

9. Bulk import

Bulk import supports FMList, MWList, WLogger, CSV, TSV, TXT, and XLSX while preventing silent timestamp swaps and unsafe station matches.



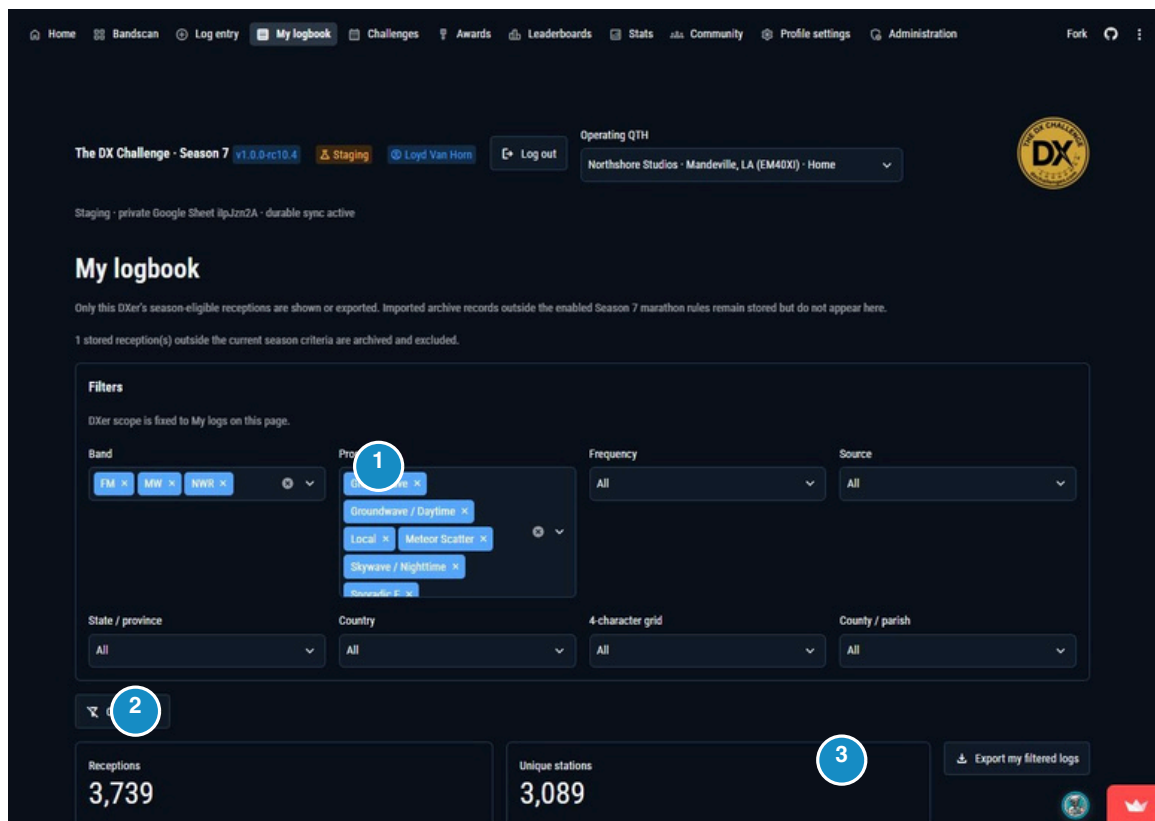
Staging screenshot with sample data. Numbered markers match the click-path list below.

- 1 Select the correct Operating QTH, choose Bulk import, and upload your own reception file.
- 2 Confirm or override the detected format, then open Review field mapping. Custom imports must map frequency, call/station, and either combined time or separate date and time.
- 3 For Custom files, explicitly choose date order and whether timestamps are UTC or local. When local, select the correct IANA time zone.
- 4 Set a fallback band, default FM/NWR propagation, SDR, and portable values for fields not mapped in the file.
- 5 Choose Build reviewed preview. Inspect Ready, Duplicate, Needs review, and Invalid totals.
- 6 Resolve held rows by confirming a canonical station or approving the uploaded station as unlisted for administrator review.
- 7 Select only Ready rows, check the review confirmation, and choose Import selected receptions.

GOOD TO KNOW: Duplicate and invalid rows are never written. Held rows are retained under My logbook → Pending logs so they can be resolved without uploading the file again.

10. My logbook: filter and export

My logbook is scoped to your own season-eligible receptions.



Staging screenshot with sample data. Numbered markers match the click-path list below.

- 1 Filter by band, propagation, frequency, source, state/province, country, 4-character grid, and county/parish.
- 2 Clear filters restores the full season view. Receptions and Unique stations counters update with every filter.
- 3 Export my filtered logs downloads only your currently filtered reception rows as CSV.
- 4 The Source column identifies station-list, manual, bulk-import, and legacy/bandscan origins.

GOOD TO KNOW: Tables elsewhere are intentionally not downloadable. The protected My logbook export never exposes the proprietary station lists or another DXer's records.

11. My logbook: edit or delete a reception

Select exactly one logbook row to activate the edit and delete controls between the counters and the table.

The screenshot shows the 'My logbook' interface. At the top, there are navigation tabs: Home, Bandscan, Log entry, My logbook (active), Challenges, Awards, Leaderboards, Stats, Community, Profile settings, and Administration. Below the tabs are filter buttons for 'Groundwave / Daytime', 'Local', 'Meteor Scatter', 'Skywave / Nighttime', and 'Sporadic E'. There are also dropdown menus for 'State / province', 'Country', '4-character grid', and 'County / parish', all set to 'All'. A 'Clear filters' button is present. Below the filters are two counters: 'Receptions 3,739' and 'Unique stations 3,089', with an 'Export my filtered logs' button. A message says 'Select a row below to activate the edit and delete controls.' Below this is a table with columns: Reception (local), band, frequency, call, station_city, station_region, station_country, station_county, station_grid, propagation, SDR, Portable, and + notes. The first row is highlighted with a red circle and the number 1. The table contains 10 rows of sample data.

Reception (local)	band	frequency	call	station_city	station_region	station_country	station_county	station_grid	propagation	SDR	Portable	+ notes
2026-09-04 20:02 CDT	MW	910	HRVS	Tegucigalpa	DX	Honduras		EK64JC	Sunset grayline	☒	☐	
2026-09-02 00:29 CDT	MW	910	HRVS	Tegucigalpa	DX	Honduras		EK64JC	Skywave / Nighttime	☒	☐	
2026-09-01 00:34 CDT	MW	910	KRBO	MICALLEN	TX	United States	Hidalgo	EL06VH	Sunrise grayline	☒	☐	
2026-08-29 05:00 CDT	MW	910	WFDF	FARMINGTON HILLS	MI	United States	Monroe	EN82HB	Sunrise grayline	☒	☐	
2026-06-11 01:03 CDT	FM	92.5	WIRN	BUHL	MIN	United States	St. Louis	EN37OL	Sporadic E	☒	☐	
2026-06-09 14:31 CDT	FM	98.3	CFLY-FM	KINGSTON	ON	CAN		FN14QK	Sporadic E	☒	☐	
2026-06-03 16:08 CDT	FM	92.7	Star	Savannah	DX	CAYMAN ISLAND		EK99IG	Sporadic E	☒	☐	
2026-05-21 17:49 CDT	FM	91.7	WCML-F	ALPENA	MI	United States	Alcona	EN75WD	Sporadic E	☒	☐	
2026-05-21 15:50 CDT	FM	88.1	WYTR	ROBBINS	NC	United States	Moore	FM05ON	Sporadic E	☒	☐	
2026-05-19 17:58 CDT	FM	107.7	WVCY-F	MILWAUKEE	WI	United States	Milwaukee	EN52XX	Sporadic E	☒	☐	

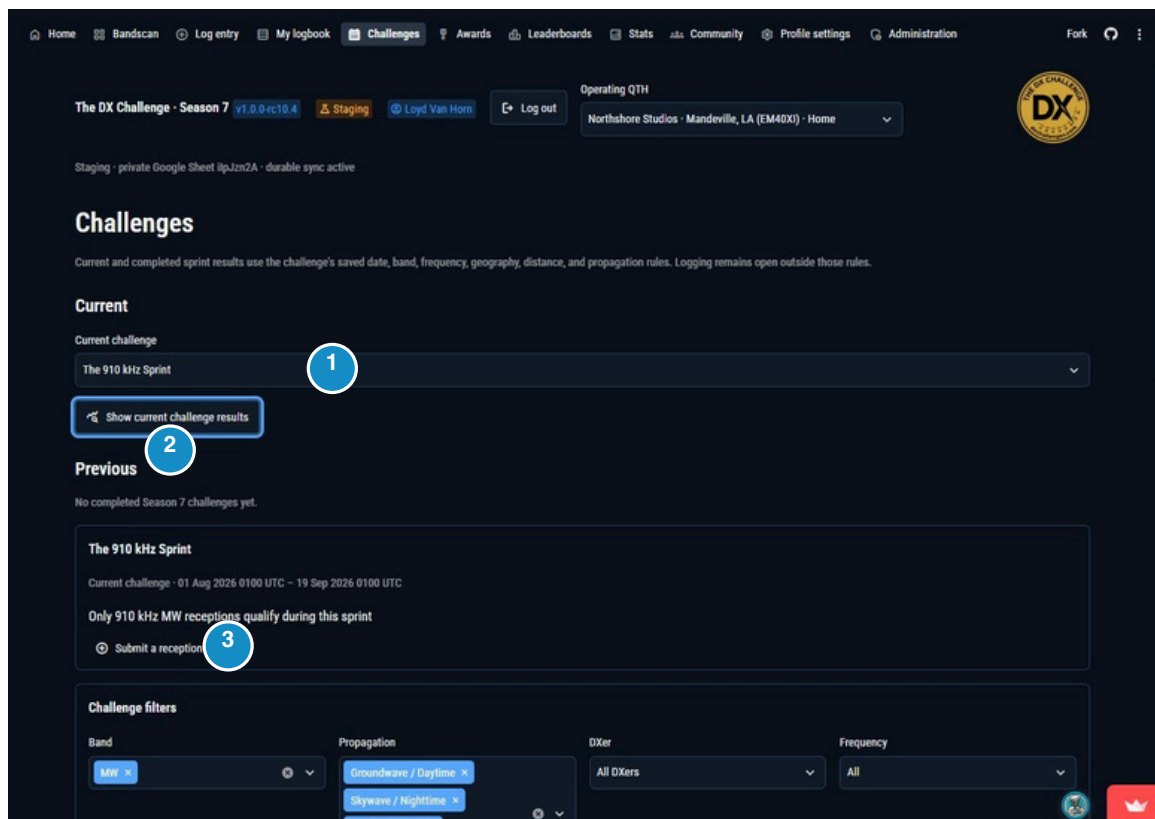
Staging screenshot with sample data. Numbered markers match the click-path list below.

- 1 Click a row in the My logbook table. The selected call and stable entry ID appear above the table.
- 2 Choose Edit selected reception to change UTC date/time, propagation/daypart, SDR, portable, or notes; then Save changes.
- 3 Choose Delete selected reception, verify the call/frequency/time in the warning, and confirm deletion.
- 4 The same stable entry ID is updated or marked deleted in the connected Google Sheet, keeping statistics and leaderboards in sync.

GOOD TO KNOW: Station identity is not editable in the user dialog. If the wrong station was chosen, delete the record and enter the correct station, or use Help and support.

12. Challenges

Challenges applies each sprint's saved date, band, frequency, geography, distance, and propagation rules without closing general season logging.



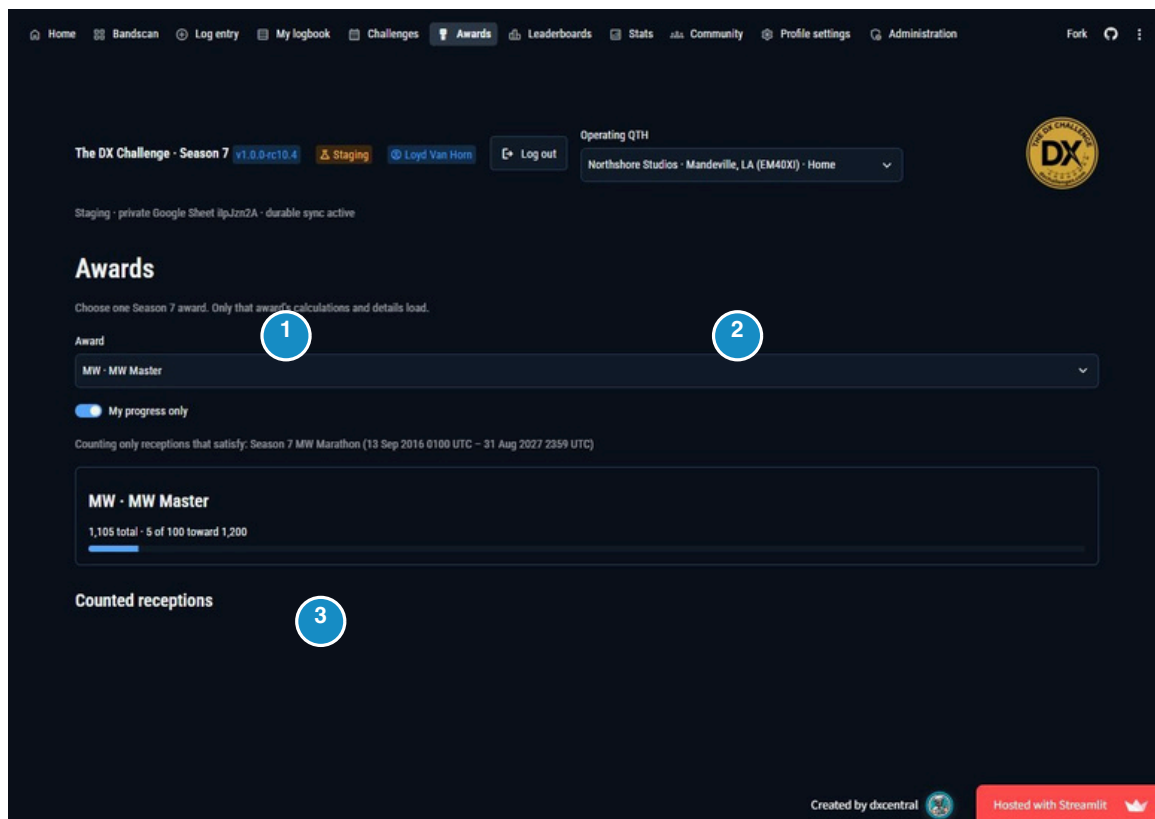
Staging screenshot with sample data. Numbered markers match the click-path list below.

- 1 Under Current, choose an active challenge and Show current challenge results. If several are active, select the one you want.
- 2 Use Submit a reception to move to Log entry; enable Active challenge filter there when you want only eligible frequencies.
- 3 Previous challenges remain selectable with their final results. Future challenges show their UTC windows but are not interactive.
- 4 Challenge filters cover band, propagation, DXer, frequency, state/province, country, 4-character grid, and county/parish.
- 5 Challenge analysis can show logs by DXer, states, Canadian provinces, Mexican states, countries, grids, counties, station locations, or paths.
- 6 Selecting a DXer or supported geography applies that choice to the counters, visualization, and qualifying reception table.

GOOD TO KNOW: Submitting outside the active sprint rules is still allowed. That reception may count for an enabled season marathon even when it does not qualify for the sprint.

13. Awards

Awards loads one season-long award at a time to keep the page fast while still exposing progress details and counted receptions.



Staging screenshot with sample data. Numbered markers match the click-path list below.

- 1 Choose an award from the Award dropdown.
- 2 Keep My progress only on for your own meter. Turn it off for the top-ten DXer table and relative progress bars.
- 3 After the base target is reached, the meter tracks progress toward the next endorsement where that award supports endorsements.
- 4 Counted receptions lists the stations/geographies contributing to the selected DXer's progress.
- 5 Grid Hunter awards always use unique 4-character Maidenhead grids.

GOOD TO KNOW: Propagation Master calculations use unique stations within each required propagation/daypart component; legacy bandscan-source rows do not satisfy those components.

14. Season award reference

Targets below reflect the current Season 7 app configuration. The live Awards page is authoritative if rules are revised.

Award	Base requirement**	Next endorsement
MW Master	700 unique MW stations	+100 stations
MW Grid Hunter	200 unique 4-character grids	+50 grids
MW County Hunter	200 unique counties/parishes	+50 counties
MW International DXer	20 unique countries	+5 countries
MW Domestic DXer	All Lower 48 states	—
MW Propagation Master	20 Daytime; 150 Sunrise; 150 Sunset; 200 Nighttime	Component progress
The Gravedigger	150 unique graveyard-channel stations	—
Master Gravedigger	200 unique graveyard stations with long-distance criteria	—
FM Master	1,000 unique FM stations	+200 stations
FM Grid Hunter	200 unique 4-character grids	+50 grids
FM County Hunter	200 unique counties/parishes	+50 counties
FM Propagation Master	100 Tropo; 100 Meteor Scatter; 100 Sporadic E	Component progress
NWR Master	100 unique NWR stations	—
NWR Grid Hunter	50 unique 4-character grids	+10 grids
NWR County Hunter	50 unique counties/parishes	+10 counties
NWR WFO Hunter	50 unique Weather Forecast Offices	+10 WFOs
NWR Propagation Master	5 Tropo; 5 Meteor Scatter; 5 Sporadic E	Component progress

****Note:** The criteria for each award/endorsement may change through the course of the season depending on participation. Any changes will be announced in the “Announcements” section of the “Home” page.

15. Leaderboards

Leaderboards compares season performance and sprint results using public display names

Staging screenshot with sample data. Numbered markers match the click-path list below.

- 1 Season leaders applies the season filters and scoring matrix to eligible receptions.
- 2 Sprint challenge leaders defaults to an active or recent sprint; use the dropdown to choose another available challenge.
- 3 Display-name changes update historical standings without creating a second DXer.

GOOD TO KNOW: Leaderboard scoring and award progress are different views: scoring can include participation and multipliers, while awards use their own unique-station/geography rules.

16. Stats: filters, counters, and table

Stats is the research dashboard. One filter set controls every counter, selected visualization, and the reception table.

The screenshot shows the Stats dashboard with the following elements:

- Filters (Marker 1):** A row of dropdown menus for Band (FM, MW, NWR), Propagation (Aurora, Groundwave, Groundwave / Daytime, Local, Meteor Scatter, Skywave / Nighttime), DXer (My logs), Frequency (All), State / province (All), Country (All), 4-character grid (All), and County / parish (All). A 'Clear filters' button is below.
- Counters (Marker 2):** A row of six boxes showing: Receptions (3,739), Unique stations (3,089), States / provinces (114), Countries (39), 4-character grids (429), and Counties / parishes (1,128).
- Map / analysis (Marker 3):** A dropdown menu set to 'Overview'.
- Table:** A table with columns 'band', 'Receptions', and 'Stations'. It shows data for FM, MW, and NWR bands.
- Filtered reception table:** A section below the table.

band	Receptions	Stations
FM	1950	1950
MW	1105	1105
NWR	24	24

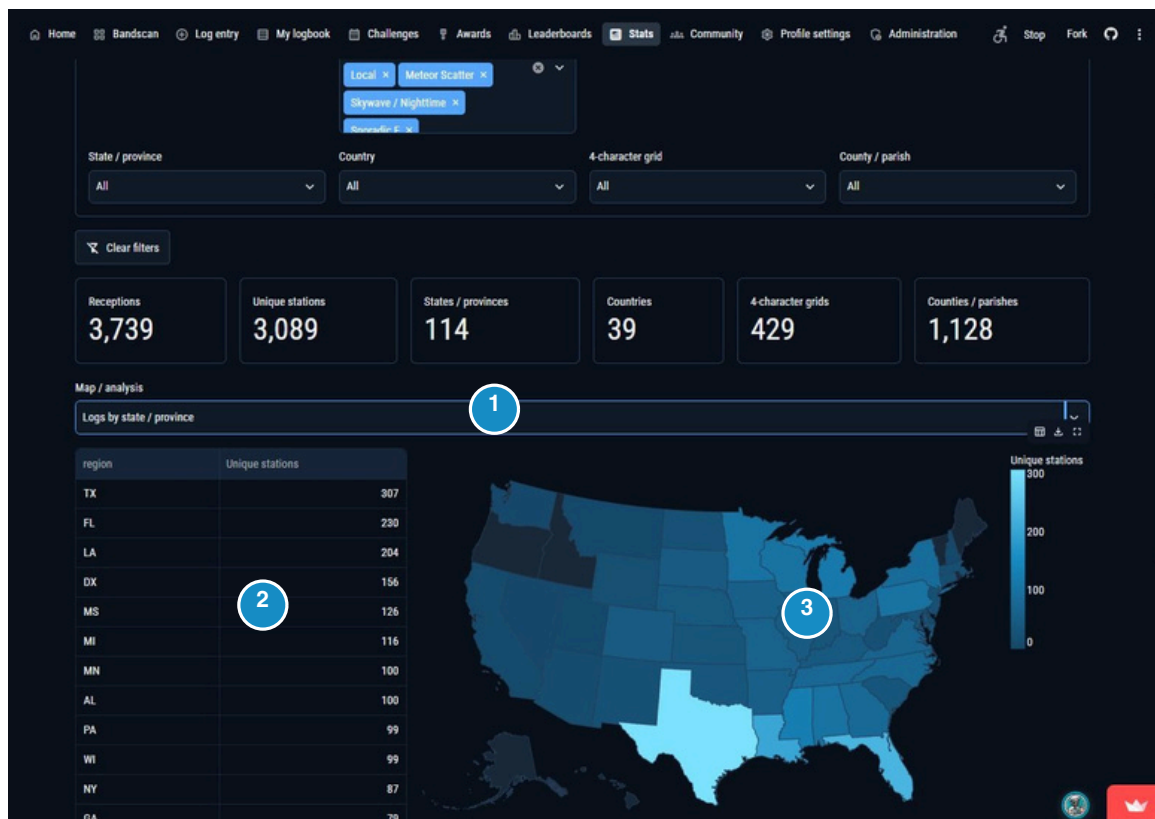
Staging screenshot with sample data. Numbered markers match the click-path list below.

- 1 Filter by band, propagation, DXer (My logs or another DXer), frequency, state/province, country, 4-character grid, and county/parish.
- 2 Counters show receptions, unique stations, states/provinces, countries, 4-character grids, and counties/parishes.
- 3 Choose one Map / analysis at a time so the app does not load every visualization at once.
- 4 Filtered reception table shows the matching logs for research; it is intentionally not downloadable.
- 5 Clear filters returns all controls to their full season scope.

GOOD TO KNOW: Stats includes only receptions meeting an enabled Season 7 marathon rule. Uploaded archive history may remain stored without appearing here.

17. Stats and challenge maps

Maps convert the current filters into geographic coverage, station points, or paths. Map colors follow the app theme.



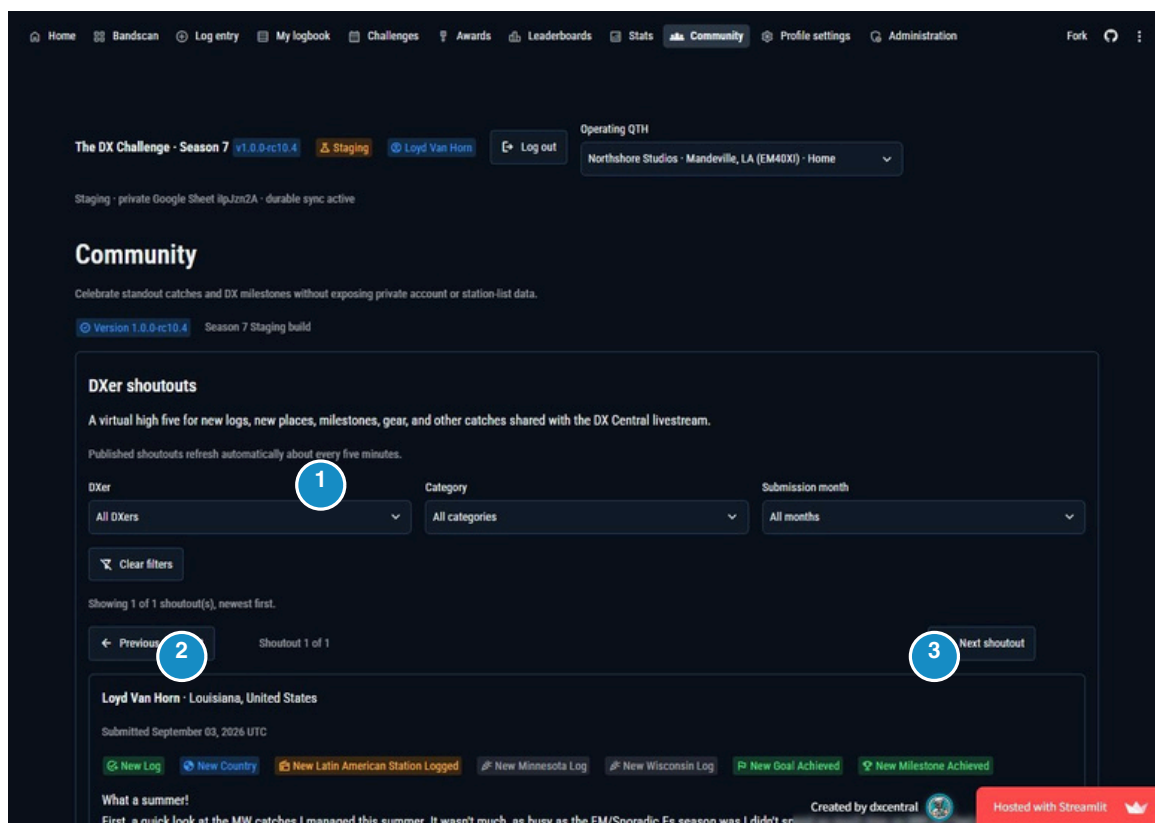
Staging screenshot with sample data. Numbered markers match the click-path list below.

- 1 Map options: logs by state/province, Canadian province, Mexican state, country, grid square, county, station locations, and paths.
- 2 Choropleth tables and maps use unique stations. Hover to see values; click a supported geography to apply it to the filters and reception table.
- 3 Country, subdivision, grid, station-location, and path maps support zoom and pan. State and county views open at a US-wide extent.
- 4 Station locations use density-scaled dots. Path maps connect the selected DXer QTH to logged stations.
- 5 Band colors are cyan for MW, green for FM, and orange for NWR; DXer QTH markers are small white points.

GOOD TO KNOW: If a map looks wrong, first check the selected DXer/QTH and filters. Station-coordinate corrections are reflected from the current station record after refresh.

18. Community

Community celebrates DX activity while keeping account data and proprietary station lists private.



Staging screenshot with sample data. Numbered markers match the click-path list below.

- 1 DXer shoutouts are loaded newest first. Filter by DXer, category, or submission month, then use Previous/Next to move through the carousel.
- 2 Category badges summarize the achievement; uploaded media shows its filename beside the media button when available.
- 3 A Read on air badge identifies shoutouts already featured on the livestream.
- 4 Achievement Corner shows recently reached season-award milestones across DXers.
- 5 Release notes show what changed in recent builds; Privacy policy and disclaimer explains app data handling.

19. Data and counting rules

The app keeps reception history flexible while making competitive totals consistent.

- 1 A station may be logged many times, but the same station at essentially the same time (approximately ± 5 minutes) is rejected as a duplicate.
- 2 Season Master awards and most geographic statistics count each DXer/station combination once within the eligible season scope.
- 3 Weekly/sprint results independently deduplicate inside that challenge's qualifying time and rule window.
- 4 All records are stored in UTC; local time is a display/import interpretation choice.
- 5 Every reception is tied to the Operating QTH used. SDR and portable flags remain part of the record and scoring inputs.
- 6 Changing your public display name never changes record ownership. Changing Home QTH does not remove alternate locations or their logs.
- 7 Only My logbook can export data, and only your own filtered receptions are included.

20. Quick reference and troubleshooting

Use these short paths when you know the outcome you need.

Goal	Click path
Log a known station	Operating QTH → Log entry → Station list → Band/Frequency → Row → Review → Submit
Log an unlisted station	Log entry → Manual entry → Identify station → Resolve location → Review → Submit
Import a file	Log entry → Bulk import → Upload → Map/time settings → Preview → Resolve → Select Ready → Import
Correct a log	My logbook → Filters → Select row → Edit selected reception → Save
Delete an accident	My logbook → Select row → Delete selected reception → Confirm
Export your logs	My logbook → Apply filters → Export my filtered logs
See a coverage map	Stats → Apply filters → Map / analysis → Choose geography/path/stations
See sprint analysis	Challenges → Select challenge → Show results → Challenge analysis
Change theme/time units	Profile settings → Display and accessibility → Apply display settings
Add a portable QTH	Profile settings → Add a receiving location → Save → choose it in Operating QTH
Get help	Profile settings → Help and support → Guided walkthrough or support ticket

Troubleshooting

- Wrong totals: clear filters and confirm the log falls inside an enabled season marathon.
- Wrong distance/daypart: confirm Operating QTH and repair incomplete location data if offered.
- Import row held: open Pending logs in My logbook and resolve the station match.
- Sync warning: do not assume the change is durable until the header returns to durable sync active; use Retry sync when offered.
- Map mismatch or uneditable station identity: submit a support ticket with the call, band, frequency, and expected location.

21. Privacy Policy and Disclaimer

The DX Challenge uses Google sign-in only to establish a stable account identity. The app does not receive or store your Google password, and it does not request access to your contacts, Gmail, Google Drive, or unrelated Google account data. To operate the challenge, the app retains the minimum profile information supplied by sign-in (account identifier, email address, and display name), the display/accessibility settings you choose, receiving locations you create, reception logs you submit, and support or feature requests you submit. This information is used only to run your account, calculate challenge results and awards, provide the community statistics described in the app, and let an administrator respond to requests. Durable challenge records are kept in a private Google Sheet controlled by DX Central and accessed by the app's restricted service account. The Sheet is not published as an account directory or made available as a station-list export.

Your precise receiving coordinates and email address are not shown in public tables or maps. Public views use your chosen display name and aggregated or reception-related data. Map exports and shared statistics may reveal approximate reception paths when you choose to create or share them.

Community shoutouts are read from a separately published DX Central response feed and display only the name, broad location, selected categories, submitted shoutout text, optional media link, and submission date that a participant provided for public livestream recognition. Extra response-Sheet columns are discarded by the app and are not sent to the Community page.

You may export your own submitted logs from My logbook, and you may edit or delete your own receptions. Proprietary station-list records are never included in exports. Deleting a reception preserves its stable record ID and deletion history so accidental or conflicting copies are not silently recreated.

This staging build is for invited testing. Data storage and retention procedures may change before the public Season 7 launch; material changes will be posted in Release notes. Participation is voluntary, and reception reports remain the responsibility of the submitting DXer.